



Table of Contents

Chicken Korma	1
Chicken Soup (Desi Style)	3
Dhaniya Chicken / Coriander Chicken / Dhonepata Chicken	4
Chicken Hakka Noodles	6
Aloo Fulkopi Posto (Potato and cauliflower cooked in poppy seed paste gravy)	8
Tandoori Chicken	10
Khatta Baingan (khatta begun)	12
Mughlai Keema Paratha	14

Chicken Korma

When an inch of oil or ghee floats upon gravy, yes its 'mughlai nawabi dish'. 'Nawab' means king. This category of curries have nice colored, rich, thick, creamy gravy. 'Chicken Korma' is my favourite one. You can easily eat this curry once in a month along with 'biryani', 'pulao', 'butter naan' or 'rumali roti'. Do not put this kind of food in your regular diet because you have to make or eat korma without any guilt, otherwise you will never enjoy the richness of mughlai food.



Ingredients

Chicken legs 2 pieces.
1 cup thinly sliced onion.
Ginger and garlic paste 2 Teaspoons.
Salt and sugar.
Hung curd 1 cup.
One cinnamon stick.
Five green cardamoms.
Four cloves.
One star anis.
5-6 black pepper corns.
Turmeric powder 2 Teaspoons.
Coriander powder 1 Teaspoon.
Cumin powder 1 Teaspoon.
Nutmeg powder ½ Teaspoon.
Mace powder ½ Teaspoon.
Red chili powder 2 Teaspoons.
1 Teaspoons garam masala powder.
Clarified butter/ ghee 6 Teaspoons.

White oil 2 Teaspoons.
Kewra water ½ Teaspoon.
Warm water.

Steps

Marinate the chicken pieces with 1 Teaspoon turmeric, red chilli powder, mustard oil and salt. Keep it aside for 1 hour.
Fry the onion slices in oil till golden brown in color. Then remove them from the pan.
Heat 2 Teaspoons ghee and 1 Teaspoon oil. Add the marinated chicken legs and fry in high flame for 5 minutes. Then keep aside.
Now in that pan add the remaining ghee. Heat it.
Add cinnamon stick, cloves, green cardamoms and star anis. Saute it for a minute.
Then add the ginger and garlic paste. Fry it for 2 minutes.
Now take ½ cup of curd, all the spice powder,

1 Teaspoon sugar and pinch of salt in a bowl.

Stir it very well.

Add the curd mixture. Cook this on slow flame for 20 minutes.

Then put the fried onion, the remaining curd and little water in a blender. Blend it to a smooth paste.

Add this paste into the pan. Stir this very well and cook it another 10 minutes.

Now add the fried chicken legs. Mix it well and Cook it for 7 minutes.

Then add some warm water and cook this with lid for 25 minutes or untill the chicken become fully tender.

Check the gravy and the chicken.

Lastly add little kewra water and garam masala powder. Mix it for 2 minutes and turn off your gas.

Let it rest for 5 minutes and then serve.

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Chicken Soup (Desi Style)

You know winter is coming and all you need is a bowl of warm soup. You can put many vegetables and proteins in it. Soup is a very healthy meal for kids. It is also very helpful for sick people. Specially in winter, you can get many varieties of vegetables from grocery store. Then why not make some soup? This one is a very simple and easy recipe. I mentioned 'desi' style because I used some whole spices (Indian) for aroma. Try this in your kitchen and make your winter morning a happy one.



Ingredients

1 cup of minced chicken.
2 cups of mix vegetables like (onion, capsicum, carrots, mushrooms, beans, corn etc.)
Whole spices (2 bay leaves, 6 black peppercorn, 5 cloves).
1 Teaspoon chopped garlic.
1 Teaspoon black pepper powder.
Salt.
½ Teaspoon vinegar.
Warm water.
4 Teaspoons white oil.
Some chopped spring onion.

Steps

Put the chicken, mix vegetables, pinch of salt and a glass of water in a pressure cooker. Give it pressure for 15-20 minutes. Everything should be cooked well.

Heat oil in a pan.

Add the whole spices and chopped garlic in hot oil. Sauté them for 30 secs.

Then add the boiled soup, vinegar, salt and black pepper powder into the oil. Cook this for 10 minutes or until you get desired consistency.

Adjust the salt and heat according to your taste.

Lastly add some chopped spring onion. Cook this for 3 minutes and turn off the heat.

Dhaniya Chicken / Coriander Chicken / Dhonepata Chicken

When I was in college, I loved to do some cooking with my mom. 'Dhaniya Chicken' was one of my teenage speciality dish. Dhaniya / dhonepata means coriander leaves. I only prefer to use garlic and don't like to use whole spices for this dish. According to me, the strong aroma of whole spices dominate the flavour of fresh coriander leaves. After a long time, last night I made 'dhonepata chicken' along with some steamed rice and enjoyed every moment of prepping, cooking and eating just like those college days . Try this in your kitchen and share some of your teenage story with me.



Ingredients

2 big chicken legs.
1 cup of onion slices.
3 cups of chopped coriander leaves.
2-3 cloves of garlic.
2-3 green chilies.
6 tbsp of curd / yogurt.
3 Teasopps of heavy cream.
Salt and sugar.
½ Teasoppn of garam masala powder.
Warm water.
5 tbsp of white oil.

Steps

Always use fresh coriander leaves for this dish. Cut the stems and wash those properly.

Put the coriander leaves, garlic and green chilies into a blender. Add a dash of water and make a smooth paste.

Add this green paste and yogurt in a mixing bowl. Mix it well with your hand. Put the chicken pieces into the marination and keep it for 1-2 hours.

Now heat oil in a pan. Add the slices of onion with pinch of salt. Fry those till become golden in color.

After that shake off some marination from the chicken legs and put it in the hot oil. Fry both sides for 5 minutes in high flame.

Then add rest of the marination, some salt and 1 Teasoppn sugar into the chicken. Mix it and

cook it in medium flame for 15 minutes.

When the oil starts separating, reduce the flame and again cook this for 15-20 minutes. If the gravy becomes dry you can add little water.

Now add some warm water and cook it till the chicken becomes fully tender.

Always make the gravy thick for this dish.

When the chicken is totally cooked add the cream. Mix it and check the seasoning. Adjust it according to your taste.

Lastly add some garam masala powder, mix it for one more time and turn off the heat.

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Chicken Hakka Noodles

It is almost impossible to find them who doesn't love chinese food, specially 'hakka noodles'. I think, this is the most frequently ordered dish in any indo-chinese restaurant. I, personally don't like any side dish with hakka noodles because this chinese dish has its own magic. I made this noodles in dinner and the taste turned out exceptionally good, the flavour was same like restaurants. Try this in your kitchen and share your 'noodles story' with me ...



Ingredients

1 pack of Hakka noodles.
10-15 chicken strips.
2 Teaspoons of beaten egg.
1 Teaspoon of cornflour.
1 cup onion slices.
Mix veg slices (capsicum, mushroom, carrots, french beans).
2 green chilies sliced.
1 clove garlic chopped.
Salt.
Black pepper 2 Teaspoons.
Msg 1 Teaspoon.
Vinegar 1 Teaspoon.
2 Teaspoons soy sauce.
3 Teaspoons chilli sauce.
White oil 5 Teaspoons.
Water.
Some chopped spring onion.

Steps

Boil the noodles (for 2 person) in water untill it becomes firm to bite.
Drain the water and wash the noodles with cold water immediately. Keep aside.
Add 2 Teaspoons of beaten egg, 1 Teaspoon cornflour and pinch of salt. Mix it very well.
Now take a wok. Heat 3 Teaspoons oil.
Add the chicken strips one by one. Fry it for 5 minutes. Then remove them from the pan.
Add the remaining oil in the pan.
Add chopped garlic. Saute it for a minute.
Add sliced onion and pinch of salt. Mix it for 4 minutes.
Then add mix veg slices and green chilies. Fry it for 5-6 minutes in high flame.
After that add msg, black pepper powder and some more salt. Mix it.
Add the chicken strips. Mix it for 2 minutes.

Then add the boiled noodles. Mix it very well.
Now add soy sauce, chilli sauce and vinegar.
Mix it well.
Adjust the salt, heat and dont make the
vegetables soggy.
Lastly add some chopped spring onion. Turn
off the heat.

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Aloo Fulkopi Posto (Potato and cauliflower cooked in poppy seed paste gravy)

Bengali without posto(poppy seed)? - impossible. Bengali without aloo(potato)? - no way. I specially can't live without these two. 'Aloo posto' or 'aloo fulkopi posto' is my favourite weekday's lunch with steamed rice and hot daal. My hubby is very fond of 'fulkopi' (cauliflower), that's why I added this in the gravy. But if you don't like you can totally skip this part. The most simple and easy recipe is this one. Here is how I made it ...



Ingredients

15-20 potato cubes.
8-9 cauliflower cubes.
½ Teaspoon nigella seeds(kalojeera).
2 green chillies.
6 Teaspoons poppy seeds.
8 Tablespoons of milk.
1 dry red chilli.
1 Teaspoon turmeric powder.
Salt and sugar.
8 tablespoons of mustard oil.
Warm water.

Steps

Soak the poppy seeds in milk/water for 2-3 hours. Then blend it with a green chilli to a very smooth paste. Keep it aside.
Wash the cauliflower cubes properly.

Heat 2 Tablespoons mustard oil in a pan.
Add the cauliflower cubes, some salt and ½ Teaspoon turmeric powder. Mix it in high flame for 4 minutes. Then cook this in medium flame for another 5 minutes.
When the cauliflowers become half tender, remove them from the pan.
Heat the remaining oil.
Add nigella seeds and 1 dry redchilli. Saute it for 30 seconds.
Then add the potato cubes, pinch of salt and turmeric powder. Mix it very well for 4 minutes.
After that add the half fried cauliflower. Mix it once.
Then add the poppy seed paste. Mix it well.
Then add some warm water, 1 green chilli, some salt and pinch of sugar.
Cook this until the vegetables become soft. If

you need more heat, you can add more green
chilies.

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Tandoori Chicken

This dish don't need any explanation. Its very popular in India and nowadays all over the world. There was a rumor that without "tandoor/oven" you cannot make tandoori. But believe me today I am sharing "oven method and gas method" of making tandoori chicken. 'Tandoor' means oven made with clay and the heat comes from charcoal. In restaurants the actual tandoor flavour comes when juices of chicken drops on the charcoal, it creates a nice smokey flavour. You will fall in love with this dish. Please give it a try at your home and prove the rumor wrong.



Ingredients

2 Chicken leg pieces.
6 Teaspoons hung curd.
Salt.
2 Teaspoons fresh ginger and garlic paste.
4 Teaspoons mustard oil.
5 Teaspoons store bought tandoori masala or
1 Teaspoon each (roasted cumin and coriander powder, red chili powder, black pepper powder, kashmiri mirch powder, garam masala powder, dry fenugreek leaf powder).
½ Teaspoon cornflour.
Some butter for basting.

Steps

Initial Steps

Wash the chicken pieces and make some slits with sharp knife. Pat dry the chicken.
Now take a big bowl. Add mustard oil.

Then add red chili powder, kashmiri red chili powder and tandoori masala (or remaining all the above mentioned powder). Mix it and let it rest for 8 minutes. From this you will get nice red color.

After that put hung curd, cornflour and salt. Mix it very well. Cornflour will help to stick the marination on the chicken while baking.
Now add the chicken pieces. Massage the chicken pieces with masala very well with your hand. Cover the bowl and keep it in refrigerator overnight or atleast 4-5 hours.

Oven method

Preheat your oven at the highest temperature for 10-15 minutes.

Place the marinated chicken pieces on a grill pan and put in the oven for 25 minutes in 450F. Adjust the temperature as per your

oven. Always place the tray on the upper rack.
Then bast some butter on the baked side.
Turn the chicken pieces on other side and follow the same procedure.
To get the smokey flavour put the tray close to the fillaments for 3 minutes each side in highest temperature.
Turn off your oven and let it rest for another 5 minutes.
Before serving chicken tandoori, bast some more butter on top.
Gas method
Take a iron skillet / pan. Heat it very well.
Put very little oil and spread all over the hot pan.
Now put the chicken pieces in the hot pan.
Dont overcrowd the pan.
Cook each side for 15-20 minutes in medium high flame. Bast some butter in between.
To get the smokey flavour turn your burner and hold the chicken pieces in direct flame each side for 1 minute.

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Khatta Baingan (khatta begun)

'Khatta' means tangy/sour and 'baingan' means eggplant/begun. Most probably this dish is from Kashmiri cuisin. I do not have much knowledge about this cuisin but I can assure you that you will never forget this eggplant recipe. Last wednesday we both wanted to eat veg in dinner and I had an eggplant(begun) in my fridge. So, I googled for some spicy veg recipes made with eggplant, and my eyes got stuck to this one. The recipe is simple and very easy to make. I just made a little change, as 'he' doesn't like tamarind (tetul/imli) in his food, I had to use yogurt instead of it. Believe me the taste came out really delicious. It goes very well with steamed rice or plain roti. Try this in your kitchen and share your story with us.



Ingredients

8-10 big cubes of eggplant.
1 cup thinly sliced onion.
1 Teaspoon ginger and garlic paste.
1 green chilli.
Whole spices(1 Teaspoon cumin seeds, 2 bay leaf, 3 green cardamoms).
Spice powder(1 Teaspoon turmeric powder, 1 Teaspoon red chilli powder, 1 Teaspoon garam masala powder).
4-5 Tablespoons of beaten yogurt / curd.
Salt and sugar.
Warm water.
5 Teaspoons mustard oil.
White oil for deep fry the eggplant cubes.

Steps

Wash the eggplant cubes very well and pat dry.
Deep fry the cubes in white oil till golden brown.
After frying remove them in a paper towel.
Heat mustard oil in a pan.
Add the whole spices in hot oil. Saute it for a minute.
Add the onion slices and pinch of salt. Fry it till golden in color.
Put all the spice powder in a bowl.
Add 3-4 Teaspoons water. Mix it.
When the oil starts separating from onion, add this spice mix water. Mix it in high flame for 2-4 minutes.

Add the ginger and garlic paste. Mix it for 1 minute.

Then add the beaten curd (you can add 3-4 Teaspoons tamarind pulp instead of curd), 1 Teaspoon sugar and salt. Mix it very well for 4 minutes.

Add some warm water and green chilli. Cook this till the oil separates.

Now add the fried eggplant cubes. Mix it gently with the masala for 3 minutes. Try not to mash the eggplants while mixing.

After that add little warm water. Cook this for 4-5 minutes. The gravy should become thick.

Check the seasoning. The taste should be tangy, spicy and sweet.

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Mughlai Keema Paratha

In Kolkata we call this 'moglai porota (paratha)'. I made this with 'keema' or minced meat, that's why it is nonveg version. The process is a bit lengthy but it is worth trying. I made dry potato curry along with 'mughlai paratha' because these two goes very well with each other. I learned the recipe from my mother-in-law. She used to make this at evening without 'keema' and we all enjoyed those parathas very much. Here is the recipe with step by step clicks. Try this in your kitchen and let me know how it turns out.



Ingredients

For chicken

- 2 cups of minced chicken.
- 1 cup finely chopped onion.
- 1 Teaspoon chopped ginger.
- 1 Teaspoon chopped garlic.
- 1 Teaspoon turmeric powder.
- 1 Teaspoon red chilli powder.
- 1 Teaspoon garam masala powder.
- 5 Teaspoons white oil.
- Salt and sugar.

For paratha

- 1 cup of flour / maida.
- 3 Teaspoons white oil.
- Salt.
- Warm water.
- 2 eggs.
- 6 Teaspoons chopped onion.

2 chopped green chillies.

Some chopped coriander leaves.

White oil for deep fry.

Steps

Heat 5 Teaspoons oil in a pan.

Add the chopped ginger and garlic. Saute it for a minute.

Then add chopped onion with pinch of salt.

Fry this for 5 minutes.

Then add the minced chicken. Mix it in high flame for 10 minutes.

Then add pinch of sugar, turmeric powder, red chilli powder and garam masala powder. Mix it and cook this for 20 minutes.

When the chicken becomes fully cooked, remove them from the pan. Let it cool down completely.

Now add the flour, some salt and 3 Teaspoons

oil in a mixing bowl. Mix it.

Then add some warm water and make a very soft dough. Add water little by little.

Knead the dough very well and apply some oil on the dough.

Cover it and let it rest for 20 minutes.

After 20 minutes take a medium size ball out of the dough.

Apply some oil and flatten it to a thin layer with the help of rolling pin.

Beat 2 eggs, chopped onion, green chilies, coriander leaves and some salt in a bowl very well.

First put some chicken mixture in the center and then put 3 Teaspoons egg mixture on top.

Fold the sides one by one.

Make it like an envelop.

Then deep fry the both sides of paratha in hot oil very well. After frying remove them in a paper towel.

After that cut a paratha into half and serve.

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